Have you ever…?: what Murphy does not tell you

Day 2 · Grammar beyond Murphy

Murphy first
Murphy red, Unit 15 (pages 40–41): the form. Do **15.1** in class, **15.2** at home. Unit 17 (pages 44–45): *ever, never, been to*. Do **17.1** in class, **17.2** at home. Unit 24 (page 59) comes on Day 3. This file adds five things the book does not explain.

1 · After "Yes, I have" the story goes into the past simple

Have you ever been to Samarkand? → **Yes, I have.** I **went** there last summer. We **saw** the Registan.
The present perfect **opens** the topic. The details (when, where, who) use the **past simple**.

This is natural in every language, and the book teaches it only in Unit 20 (Week 12).

2 · How many times?

never · once · twice · three times · many times · a few times
*I've been to Bukhara **twice**. I've **never** been to Khiva. Have you **ever** met a famous person?*
Also: *This is the **first time** I've seen a real castle.*

3 · been to / gone to

*She **has been to** Paris.* = she visited and she is back. *She **has gone to** Paris.* = she is there now.
*I've been **to** London. (visit) I've been **in** London for two days. (I am still here)*

4 · American English

The third form of *get* is **gotten** in American English: *I've gotten better at English.* British: got.
Americans also often use the past simple with *ever, never, just*: *Did you ever see a famous person?* — both are correct.

5 · The Russian trap

Russian has no helper: «Ты был в Париже?» → ***Have** you been to Paris?* (don't forget have / has).
✗ I ~~have been in Paris last year~~ → ✓ I **went** to Paris last year. (with *last year*: past simple, see Week 12)
✗ I ~~have seen~~ him yesterday → ✓ I saw him yesterday.

Practice

Day 2 · Practice 1

What to do: Exercises 1–2 in class, alone, then check. Exercise 3: the class translates aloud, one sentence each.

1 been or gone? (to / in)

1. “Where is Tom?” “He’s ___ to the shop. He’ll be back in five minutes.”
2. I’ve ___ to Samarkand three times. It’s a lovely city.
3. We’ve ___ in this room for two hours: let’s open the window.
4. My parents have ___ to the cinema. The house is empty.
5. Have you ever ___ to Bukhara?
6. She’s not here. She’s ___ out.
7. I’ve never ___ to a concert.
8. Karim has ___ to London for a week. He comes back on Friday.

2 Answer: “Yes, I have” + one detail in the past simple

1. Have you ever met a famous person? (Where? When?)
2. Have you ever been to another country? (Which? When?)
3. Have you ever won a prize? (What? When?)
4. Have you ever eaten something strange? (What?)
5. Have you ever lost something important? (What? Where?)
6. Have you ever seen a ghost or a UFO? (Tell the story.)

3 Translate into English

1. Ты когда-нибудь был в Самарканде?
2. Я никогда не видел принца.
3. Она была в Лондоне дважды.
4. Он уехал в Ташкент (он сейчас там).
5. Это первый раз, когда я вижу замок.
6. Вы когда-нибудь встречали знаменитого человека?
7. Мы были в горах три раза.

Practice 2

Day 2 · Practice 2

What to do: Alone, then read your sentences aloud.

4 Ask your partner: Have you ever...?

Ask 8 questions: *Have you ever... visited a castle / met a king / read a book about a prince / won a prize / seen a famous person / been on TV / written a poem / climbed a mountain?* Write 4 answers in full sentences: *Mia has never been on TV. She has climbed a mountain twice.*

5 Complete the dialogue: present perfect or past simple

A: (1 you / ever / meet) _____ a famous person?

B: Yes, I (2 have) _____. I (3 meet) _____ a famous singer last year.

A: Where (4 you / meet) _____ her?

B: At the airport. She (5 sit) _____ next to me.

A: (6 you / ever / be) _____ to a concert?

B: No, I (7 never / be) _____ to one. A: I (8 be) _____ to three concerts. The last one (9 be) _____ in June. B: (10 you / enjoy) _____ it? A: Yes, a lot!

Answers · Day 2 grammar

For the teacher

1 gone · been · been · gone · been · gone · been · gone

2 Own answers: Yes, I have + a past simple detail.

3 Have you ever been to Samarkand? · I have never seen a prince. · She has been to London twice. · He has gone to Tashkent. · This is the first time I have seen a castle. · Have you ever met a famous person? · We have been to the mountains three times.

4 Own answers.

5 Have you ever met · have · met · did you meet · sat · Have you ever been · have never been · have been · was · Did you enjoy